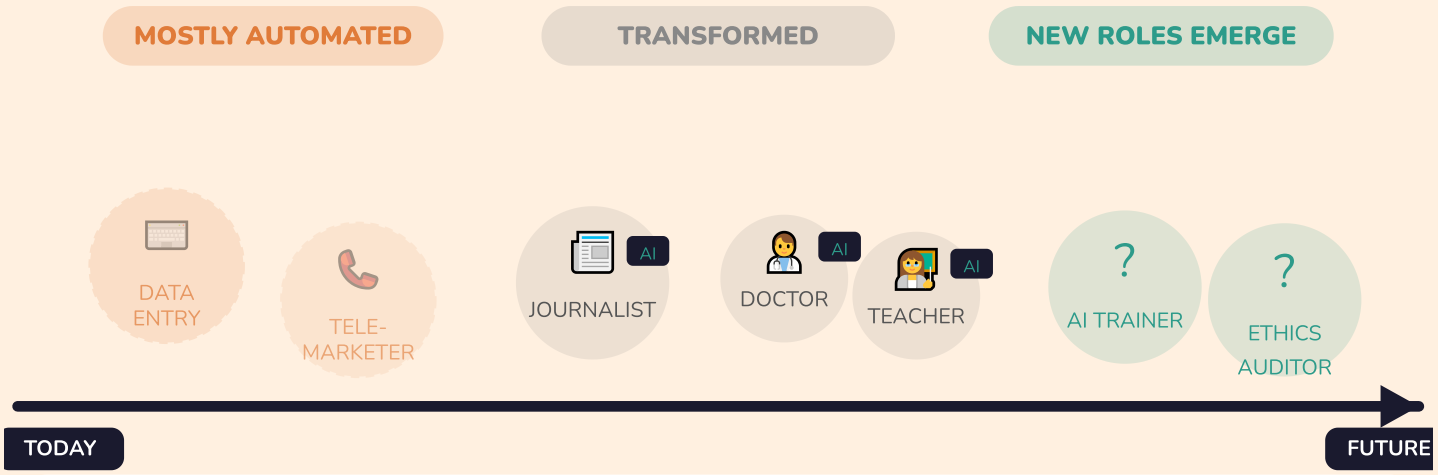
WILL AI CHANGE JOBS?

Which jobs will AI change, and what does that mean for people?



AI IS MORE LIKELY TO AUTOMATE TASKS WITHIN JOBS THAN TO ELIMINATE ENTIRE JOBS

Writing reports	Diagnosing X-rays	Empathy & care	Oversight of AI
→ automated	→ AI-assisted	→ stays human	→ new role

But transitions affect real people — unevenly

SORT PREDICT IMAGINE

WILL AI CHANGE JOBS?

The goal is not prediction but structured thinking about change: what tasks are AI-susceptible, what human skills remain irreplaceable, and how new roles emerge. Avoid catastrophism or naive optimism — aim for informed complexity.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Give groups cards with 12 job titles: doctor, lorry driver, teacher, graphic designer, plumber, data analyst, actor, accountant, chef, journalist, social worker, programmer.
2. Sort them into three zones: "AI will do most of this," "AI will change how this is done," "AI will have little effect on this."
3. Groups compare their sorts. What criteria did they use? What surprised them? Which jobs were most debated?
4. Each student picks one job and writes: what would this job look like in 20 years if AI is common? What new skill would a person need?

MATERIALS

- Job title cards (print and cut — 12 per group)
- Three sorting zone labels
- Criteria discussion anchor
- Individual futures writing sheet
- Group comparison display space

REFLECTION

- Is losing a boring task always a loss?
- What happens to people whose jobs are automated?
- Are there things you would not want AI to do, even if it could?
- What skills will be most valuable in an AI world?

REALITY CHECK

AI is more likely to automate tasks than entire jobs.

But some jobs will shrink significantly, and the transition affects real people unevenly — particularly those in lower-paid, more routine work who have fewer resources to retrain or adapt.

DIGITAL GAME

Job Evolution Timeline

Scan to play →